

Nutrition Program Guide

Version 1.5 | Last Updated: January 15, 2025 | Owner: Rachel Kim, Nutrition Coach

1. Overview

This guide provides nutritional guidelines for all gym members. Proper nutrition is essential for achieving fitness goals — exercise alone accounts for only 20-30% of body composition changes, while nutrition drives 70-80%. All members are encouraged to log their meals in our nutrition tracking system and attend at least one nutrition consultation per quarter.

2. Daily Macronutrient Targets by Goal

Goal	Calories	Protein	Carbs	Fat
Weight Loss	TDEE - 500	1.8g/kg body weight	30-35% of calories	25-30% of calories
Muscle Building	TDEE + 300	2.0g/kg body weight	40-45% of calories	20-25% of calories
Maintenance	TDEE	1.6g/kg body weight	40-50% of calories	25-30% of calories
Endurance	TDEE + 200	1.4g/kg body weight	50-55% of calories	20-25% of calories

3. Meal Timing

Pre-workout meal: Eat 1-2 hours before exercise. Focus on easily digestible carbs and moderate protein. Example: banana with peanut butter, or oatmeal with protein powder. Avoid high-fat meals immediately before training as they slow digestion. Post-workout nutrition: Consume protein within 30-60 minutes after training. Target 20-40g protein plus carbs to replenish glycogen. A protein shake with fruit is ideal for convenience. Whole food meals are equally effective if consumed within the window. Daily meal frequency: 3-5 meals per day, spaced 3-4 hours apart. There is no metabolic advantage to eating more frequently — choose a pattern that supports adherence. The most important factor is hitting daily calorie and protein targets.

4. Hydration Guidelines

Minimum daily water intake: 2.5 liters for women, 3.0 liters for men. During exercise, drink 200-300ml every 15-20 minutes. For sessions longer than 60 minutes, consider an electrolyte supplement. Dehydration of just 2% body weight can reduce exercise performance by up to 25%. Signs of inadequate hydration: dark urine, fatigue, headache, and decreased workout performance. Members should track water intake in the nutrition logging system alongside meals.

5. Supplement Recommendations

Supplement	Who Needs It	Recommended Dose	Timing
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Whey Protein	Members not meeting protein target	25-30g per serving	Post-workout
Creatine Monohydrate	Strength-focused members	5g daily	Any time, consistent
Vitamin D	All members (especially winter)	2000-4000 IU daily	With a meal
Omega-3 Fish Oil	Members with joint issues	1-2g EPA+DHA daily	With a meal
Electrolytes	Heavy sweaters, 60+ min sessions	Per label	During exercise

6. Special Dietary Considerations

Members with dietary restrictions (vegetarian, vegan, gluten-free, allergies) should schedule a one-on-one consultation with Rachel Kim to create a customized meal plan. Vegetarian and vegan members should pay special attention to protein sources: legumes, tofu, tempeh, seitan, and protein supplements can all help meet targets. Members with medical conditions (diabetes, kidney disease, eating disorders) must provide physician clearance before starting any nutrition program.

7. Nutrition Logging Requirements

All members on a structured nutrition plan must log meals at least 5 days per week. Logs should include: meal type, food description, estimated calories, and macronutrient breakdown. Water intake should be logged daily. Trainers review nutrition logs weekly for their personal training clients. Members consistently exceeding calorie targets by more than 20% will be flagged for a nutrition counseling session. Logs are reviewed during quarterly health assessments.